THE COURSE OF THE GREAT WAR (1914–1918)

COMPLETE INQUIRY SPINES, EXTENDED WRITING TASKS, LITERARY READING EXTRACTS & SPACED RETRIEVAL COMPANION

Scholar Name: _____ **Form:** _____ **Teacher:** _____ **Year:** _____



The Menin Road (1919) by Paul Nash • Imperial War Museums (ART 2242). Commissioned by the British War Memorials Committee, this iconic modernist masterpiece captures the apocalyptic devastation of the Ypres Salient, echoing the wartime memoirs of Siegfried Sassoon and Ernst Jünger.

ENQUIRY / HISTORICAL FOCUS	CLASSROOM ESSAY	TASK A: READ-ALOUD	TASK B: QUIZ	PARENT SIGN & DATE
Enquiry 1: 1914 & Colours	[ ] Emerging [ ] Secure	[ ] Read Aloud	[/ 6]	_____
Enquiry 2: Trenches & Haig	[ ] Emerging [ ] Secure	[ ] Read Aloud	[/ 6]	_____
Enquiry 3: Global Empire Fronts	[ ] Emerging [ ] Secure	[ ] Read Aloud	[/ 6]	_____
Enquiry 4: Home Front & Women	[ ] Emerging [ ] Secure	[ ] Read Aloud	[/ 6]	_____
Enquiry 5: Versailles & Flawed Peace	[ ] Emerging [ ] Secure	[ ] Read Aloud	[/ 6]	_____

WEEKLY DISCIPLINARY LEARNING ARCHITECTURE:

1. CLASSROOM INQUIRY:
Complete the 5-Stage Inquiry Spine and construct extended writing tasks in class.

2. ORAL HOME READING:
Read the facing literary extract aloud to a parent with fluency and expression.

3. PARENT DISCUSSION:
Discuss the targeted hinge question together. Parent initials the verification box.

4. CLOSED-BOOK RETRIEVAL:
Complete the 6-question quiz from memory and scan QR to self-check.

UNIT DIGITAL HUB
QUIZZES & LESSONS

Why were young British men so desperate to volunteer for the slaughter of 1914?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 Aug 1914 • What forced Britain to launch Kitchener's urgent call for 500,000 volunteers?

- Small Regular Army
- No Conscription
- Kitchener's Dire Call

2 Aug–Sept 1914 • How did the invasion of Belgium spark genuine moral outrage and civic duty?

- 1839 Treaty of London
- German Atrocities
- Crusade for Law

3 Sept 1914 • Why did workplace camaraderie and local pride drive the formation of Pals Battalions?

- Pals Battalions Formed
- Pompey Pals (14th/15th Hants)
- Fight Alongside Mates

4 Autumn 1914 • In what ways did poverty, adventure, and the King's Shilling lure young recruits?

- Regular Pay & Food
- Escape Factory Drudgery
- Over by Christmas

5 Late 1914 • How did state propaganda and social coercion make refusal to enlist unbearable?

- Kitchener Finger Poster
- White Feather Movement
- Unbearable Social Shame

In August and September 1914 alone, over 750,000 British men volunteered—creating the largest citizen army in British history.

Enquiry Writing Task [12 marks • 15 mins]

Explain why young British men volunteered in such massive numbers in the autumn of 1914. [12 marks]

Stimulus: **The moral outrage surrounding the German invasion of Belgium (1914)** | **The creation of civic Pals Battalions (e.g. Pompey Pals)** *(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)*

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:
One primary reason was... • This encouraged enlistment because... • Furthermore, social pressure contributed to... • Crucially, shared identity ensured that... • In consequence, this resulted in...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:
Pals Battalions • Lord Kitchener • Treaty of London • Pompey Pals • King's Shilling • White Feather • voluntary enlistment • civic patriotism • 750,000 recruits

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 12–13

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 12–13 →

Milestone 1 (August 1914): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 12–13). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out Lord Kitchener's recruiting appeal, 750,000 volunteers in eight weeks, and civic Pals Battalions.

The Pompey Pals (14th & 15th Battalions, Hampshire Regiment) were formed by local Portsmouth and Fareham dockers, clerks, and sportsmen.

Memoirs of an Infantry Officer

By Siegfried Sassoon • Captain, Royal Welch Fusiliers & War Poet (MC)

FRONTLINE WAR MEMOIR (1914)



Captain Siegfried Sassoon CBE MC, Royal Welch Fusiliers. Decorated frontline officer and war poet.

AUTHOR CONTEXT & HISTORICAL BACKGROUND:

Siegfried Sassoon was an English poet and officer in the Royal Welch Fusiliers awarded the Military Cross for bravery. In his celebrated wartime memoirs, he records the naive, sporting enthusiasm with which young British men volunteered in August 1914 and the sudden, chilling encounter with the realities of the casualty lists.

SCAN FOR AUDIO READ-ALOUD (SEND)

I was sitting in the pavilion at the village cricket ground on an idyllic August afternoon when the extraordinary news arrived... To me, as an irresponsible young gentleman with nothing better to do than hunt foxes and score occasional runs, the sudden prospect of European war seemed like a grand adventure, a chivalric crusade that had arrived just in time to rescue our generation from the dull routine of modern peacetime.

Everyone around me was swept along by the same strange fever. In the market towns and city recruiting stations, young clerks, schoolboys, shop assistants, and farm labourers queued for hours in the stifling August heat. Brass bands marched through the high streets playing patriotic anthems, church bells rang, and proud mothers pinned ribbons to their sons' lapels. We were assured by politicians and newspapers that the conflict would be settled within six months, that the Kaiser would be humbled, and that we should all return home before Christmas crowned with laurels of victory.

...It was only later, when the transport trains rolled into midnight stations and the first battalion casualty lists appeared in the Times, that the terrible silence descended. The names of boys I had played cricket against at school and shared benches with at university were printed row upon row in tiny black letters, grouped under the brutal heading: "Killed in Action." The heroic romance had vanished in an instant; the chivalric tournament was an illusion. We were not entering an adventure—we were being fed into an unrelenting industrial factory of death.

VOCABULARY VAULT (KEY TERMINOLOGY):

Chivalry: The medieval knightly code of honour, bravery, and self-sacrifice.
Laurels: A traditional Roman symbol of military victory and triumphant return.
Battalion: A military unit of roughly 1,000 frontline soldiers.

PARENT & SCHOLAR ORAL DISCUSSION GUIDE:

Think: What metaphor does Sassoon use at the end to describe what the war truly became? Contrast Sassoon's initial excitement at the cricket ground with his horror upon reading the casualty lists.

[ ] **Oral Reading Verification:** Scholar read extract aloud with expression & accuracy **Parent Initial:** _____ **Date:** _____

Enquiry Retrieval Quiz: Complete in black ink from memory. Do not peek at notes. Milestones: Q1–2 Bronze • Q3–4 Silver • Q5–6 Gold

1. ► Who appeared on famous recruitment posters pointing his finger with the slogan "Your Country Needs You"?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

2. ► What was the nickname given to battalions of friends, workmates, and neighbours who enlisted together in 1914?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

3. ►► Why did hundreds of thousands of young British men rush to enlist in August and September 1914?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

4. ►► What symbol of cowardice was publicly handed to young men in civilian clothes on British streets?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

5. ►►► Why did the concept of "Pals Battalions" ultimately prove to be a catastrophic social tragedy?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

6. ►►► How did the transition from a small professional army to a mass citizen army transform British society?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Lord Kitchener | Pals Battalions | White Feather | Propaganda | Over by Christmas | BEF (120,000) | **Score: [/ 6]**

Did British military generals make trench slaughter worse, or was Haig trapped in an industrial learning curve?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 Autumn 1914 • What forced armies underground into a 400-mile line of industrial stalemate?

- Race to the Sea
- Deadly Machine Guns
- Digging In to Survive

2 1915 • How was the three-tier trench system constructed, traversed, and defended?

- Zig-Zag Trench Lines
- Deep Concrete Dugouts
- Barbed Wire Traps

3 1915–1916 • What lethal physical and psychological trauma did infantry endure in the mud?

- Trench Foot & Frozen Mud
- Relentless Heavy Shelling
- Shell Shock Trauma

4 1 July 1916 • Why did the First Day of the Somme become the bloodiest disaster in British history?

- 7-Day Bombardment
- Barbed Wire Intact
- 57,470 Casualties

5 1916–1918 • Was Sir Douglas Haig a callous "butcher" or a commander learning total war?

- Frontal Attacks in Mud
- Hard War Lessons Learnt
- Tanks & Combined Arms

On 1 July 1916, the British Army suffered 57,470 casualties—including 19,240 dead—the bloodiest single day in British military history.

Task A: Describe Two Features [4 marks • 5 mins]

FEATURE DRILL

Describe two features of the trench defensive systems on the Western Front. [4 marks]

Sentence Stems: Feature 1: One key feature was... • Detail: Specifically, this meant that... • Feature 2: A second key feature was... • Detail: This was designed to...

Task B: Explain Why [8 marks • 10 mins]

STRUCTURED WRITING

Explain why the First Day of the Somme (1 July 1916) resulted in catastrophic British casualties. [8 marks]

Stimulus: **The failure of the 7-day artillery bombardment to cut German barbed wire** | **German soldiers sheltering in deep underground concrete dugouts**

Analytical Connectives: *The primary cause of the catastrophic casualties was... • This proved fatal for advancing infantry because... • Furthermore, defensive firepower meant that... • Consequently, the outcome was...*

Key Terms: General Sir Douglas Haig • 7-day bombardment • uncut barbed wire • concrete dugouts • Spandau Maxim machine guns • No Man's Land • 57,470 casualties

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 12–13

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 12–13 →

Milestones 3 & 4 (1916): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 12–13). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out 1 July 1916 on the Somme (57,470 casualties, intact wire) and September 1916 Mark I tanks at Flers-Courcelette.

Historians remain divided over Douglas Haig: 1960s critics labelled him a "butcher", while modern scholars view him as a commander mastering an unprecedented technological revolution.

Storm of Steel

By Ernst Jünger • Frontline Officer, German 73rd Hanoverian Regiment (Pour le Mérite)

EYEWITNESS COMBAT MEMOIR (1915–1916)



Soldiers standing in waterlogged mud in a frontline trench on the Western Front • Imperial War Museums (IWM Q 51551).

AUTHOR CONTEXT & HISTORICAL BACKGROUND:

Ernst Jünger was a German frontline officer wounded fourteen times who fought continuously on the Western Front from 1914 to 1918. His 1920 memoir Storm of Steel (In Stahlgewittern) provides an astonishing, unromanticized German eyewitness account of technological industrial bombardment in the trenches.

SCAN FOR AUDIO READ-ALOUD (SEND)

The earth shook, the sky was a raging cauldron of black smoke and blinding fire, and the deafening roar of the heavy artillery stunned our senses until conscious thought itself became impossible. We huddled packed together in deep subterranean dugouts carved thirty feet into the damp chalk, listening with racing hearts to the relentless pounding of the high-explosive shells detonating overhead. Every direct hit sent shockwaves rippling through the rock, extinguishing our candles and showering our steel helmets in suffocating chalk dust.

When the bombardment finally lifted, we scrambled up the shattered steps into the daylight. The trench was no longer a trench; it had been violently obliterated into a chaotic lunar wilderness of craters filled with foul stagnant water, tangled coils of severed barbed wire, and unburied corpses. Machine guns from the opposing ridges swept the ruined parapet with rapid metallic chatter, spraying deadly streams of lead that cut down any soldier who dared raise his head even an inch above the rim.

...In this monstrous landscape of pulverized chalk and iron, individual human courage counted for almost nothing against the mechanical supremacy of modern industrial war. The machine gunner did not need personal bravery or martial skill; he merely depressed the cold firing button to mow down an entire advancing company in minutes. It was no longer a contest of man against man, but the brutal annihilation of fragile human flesh by unfeeling machinery.

VOCABULARY VAULT (KEY TERMINOLOGY):

Artillery: Large-calibre heavy guns capable of firing explosive shells over long distances.
Traverse: A bank of earth or sandbags built across a trench to contain blast shockwaves.
Attrition: Wearing down enemy strength and manpower through continuous losses.

PARENT & SCHOLAR ORAL DISCUSSION GUIDE:

Think: Why does Jünger conclude that individual human courage counted for almost nothing in the trenches? Discuss whether British or German soldiers faced identical horrors in No Man's Land.

[ ] Oral Reading Verification: Scholar read extract aloud with expression & accuracy **Parent Initial:** _____ **Date:** _____

Enquiry Retrieval Quiz: Complete in black ink from memory. Do not peek at notes. Milestones: Q1–2 Bronze • Q3–4 Silver • Q5–6 Gold

7. ► Which weapon was responsible for approximately 60% of all combat casualties on the Western Front?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

8. ► What painful medical condition was caused by soldiers standing in cold, waterlogged mud for days?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

9. ►► Why were frontline trenches constructed in a zig-zag or traverse pattern rather than straight lines?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

10. ►► Why did the week-long British artillery bombardment fail to destroy German defenses before the Somme in 1916?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

11. ►►► Why is Field Marshal Sir Douglas Haig remembered both as the "Butcher of the Somme" and the architect of victory?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

12. ►►► How did the development of tanks and creeping barrages eventually break the trench deadlock in 1918?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: No Man's Land | Trench Foot | Heavy Artillery | Sir Douglas Haig | The Somme (1916) | Combined Arms | **Score: [/ 6]**

Why were the military contributions of 4 million colonial troops and labourers marginalized in postwar British memory?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 1914 • Why was Britain completely dependent on mobilising 4 million imperial subjects?

- Troops from Five Continents
- Vital Wheat & Oil Ships
- Global Supply Lifeline

2 1914–1915 • How crucially did 1.5 million Indian soldiers save the crumbling Allied line at Ypres?

- Indian Troops Save Flanders
- Freezing Mud & Thin Khaki
- First Asian Soldier Wins VC

3 1915 • Why did the catastrophe of Gallipoli forge national identity for Australia and New Zealand?

- Anzac Cove Steep Cliffs
- Ottoman Machine Guns
- Birth of ANZAC Legend

4 1916–1918 • In what ways did the Chinese Labour Corps and African Pioneers sustain Allied logistics?

- 140,000 Chinese Labourers
- Unloading Heavy Shells
- Guarded Curfew Camps

5 Post-1918 • Why were non-white colonial soldiers denied equal pensions, medals, and remembrance?

- No Marked African Graves
- Buried in Anonymous Pits
- Victory Parade Erasure

Over 1.5 million Indian soldiers served in the Great War; Sepoy Khudadad Khan was the first South Asian recipient of the Victoria Cross.

Enquiry Writing Task [8 marks • 10 mins]

HISTORIOGRAPHICAL ANALYSIS

INTERPRETATION 1 • LORD CURZON, BRITISH WAR CABINET MINISTER, SPEECH AT ROYAL ALBERT HALL (1917)

"The Indian Army and the troops from our dominions have rushed forward with magnificent devotion to defend the King-Emperor. Side by side with their British brothers-in-arms, they have shed their blood on the plains of Flanders, Gallipoli, and Egypt. This imperial brotherhood proves that the British Empire is held together not by force, but by mutual love, loyalty, and common sacrifice."

INTERPRETATION 2 • DAVID OLUSOGA, MODERN BRITISH HISTORIAN, THE WORLD'S WAR (2014)

"Over four million non-white men were mobilised as combatants and labourers by Britain. Yet their treatment was defined by systemic racism. Black and Asian soldiers were barred from becoming officers, paid a fraction of British wages, and subjected to brutal floggings. After 1918, the Imperial War Graves Commission deliberately refused to give African dead individual headstones. Their sacrifice was whitewashed from British national memory."

Task A: Explain how Interpretations 1 and 2 differ about the experiences of colonial troops. [4 marks]

PART B

Sentence Stems: Interpretation 1 emphasizes that colonial troops were treated with... • In contrast, Interpretation 2 argues that their service was characterized by... • Specifically, Interpretation 1 claims... whereas Interpretation 2 reveals...

Task B: Suggest one reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ about the role of empire soldiers. [4 marks]

PART C

Scaffolded Sentence Stems: One reason why Interpretations 1 and 2 differ is because they have a different focus... • Specifically, Interpretation 1 focuses primarily on... • In contrast, Interpretation 2 focuses more on... • As a result, the authors reach different conclusions because...

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 12–13

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 12–13 →

Milestones 2 & 6 (1915 & 1917–18): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 12–13). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out the April 1915 Gallipoli ANZAC landings alongside 1.5 million Indian troops and 4 million Empire personnel.

Enlistment, Empire Landings & The Somme (1914–1916)

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Causes & Context to the left • Events & Consequences to the right).

← INVASION OF BELGIUM — **Aug 1914 Rush to the Colours & Pals Battalions** (Enq 1) — 750,000 VOLUNTEERS IN 8 WEEKS →

← KNOCK OUT OTTOMAN FRONT — **Apr 1915 Gallipoli & ANZAC Landings** (Enq 3) — 8-MONTH TRENCH STALEMATE →

← 7-DAY SHELLING & WIRE — **1 Jul 1916 First Day on the Somme** (Enq 2) — 19,240 KILLED & PALS LOSSES →

← TRENCH DEADLOCK — **Sep 1916 Mark I Tanks at Flers-Courcelette** (Enq 2) — COMBINED-ARMS BREAKTHROUGH →

CONTINUE TO PART 2 (1916–1919) ON FACING PAGE ➔

Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas: Connecting enlistment, trench attrition, and armoured innovation builds durable historical memory.

Conscription, Total War & The Flawed Peace (1916–1919)

REVISION MIND-MAP CANVAS: At the end of each lesson, use the app's *Consolidate Station* to retrieve your keywords and branch out your mind-map across the open page (Pressures & Turning Points to the left • Outcomes & Legacy to the right).

← U-BOAT STARVATION THREAT

1916–17 **Conscription & Canary Girls** (Enq 4)

1M WOMEN IN MUNITIONS →

← 1.5M INDIAN SOLDIERS

1917–18 **Global Empire Mobilisation** (Enq 3)

4M EMPIRE PERSONNEL FIGHT →

← HINDENBURG LINE BROKEN

11 Nov 1918 **Hundred Days & Armistice** (Enq 5)

FOCH'S CARRIAGE CEASEFIRE →

← ARTICLE 231 WAR GUILT

28 Jun 1919 **Signing of Treaty of Versailles** (Enq 5)

£6.6BN REPARATIONS & FRAGILE PEACE →

SPINE COMPLETE (1914–1919) ➔

Indian Voices of the Great War: Soldiers' Letters

By David Omissi (ed.) & Sepoys of the Indian Army • Frontline Sepoys & Sowars, Indian Expeditionary Force

FRONTLINE SOLDIERS' LETTERS (1914–1918)



Sikh machine gunners and Indian Army troops on the Western Front, 1915.

AUTHOR CONTEXT & HISTORICAL BACKGROUND:

Over 1.3 million Indian soldiers and personnel served in the British Indian Army across Europe, the Middle East, and Africa. Their letters home, censored by British military authorities, reveal the shock of industrial warfare in the freezing mud of Flanders and their pride in defending their regiment's honour.

SCAN FOR AUDIO READ-ALOUD (SEND)

The fighting in this foreign land is beyond human description. Do not think, my brothers, that this war is like any conflict we have heard of in old times or read of in ancient poems. It is not war; it is a mechanical monster that eats living men. The cannon fire never ceases for a single hour, day or night. Shrapnel bursts overhead like thunder, raining jagged iron from the sky, while machine-gun bullets hiss past our ears like venomous serpents.

We are stationed in frontline trenches where freezing mud reaches our waists, and the bitter European winter cuts through our woollen coats like sharpened knives. Many of our fellow sepoys have fallen sick with pneumonia and the agony of frostbite, their feet swollen and blackened by the damp. We were brought across the black water from the warm sun of Hindustan into this frozen slaughterhouse. Yet despite the cold and the terror, our regiments stand firm like iron walls, determined to preserve the honour and izzat of our ancestors, refusing to yield a single foot of ground to the enemy.

...Write to our village and tell my dear mother not to grieve if I do not return to her embrace. A warrior who dies fighting bravely on the battlefield achieves everlasting honour in both worlds. But I implore you, tell my younger brothers to remain behind in the village to plow the fields and tend the cattle; one son sacrificed to this terrible European fire is more than enough for our household.

VOCABULARY VAULT (KEY TERMINOLOGY):

Sepoy: An Indian frontline soldier serving in the British Indian Army.
Shrapnel: Small metal balls packed in artillery shells, sprayed upon detonation.
Frostbite: Tissue injury caused by extreme exposure to damp cold conditions.

PARENT & SCHOLAR ORAL DISCUSSION GUIDE:

Think: What does the Indian soldier mean when he calls the war 'a monster that eats men'? Discuss why colonial soldiers fought with such dedication thousands of miles from home.

[ ] Oral Reading Verification: Scholar read extract aloud with expression & accuracy **Parent Initial:** _____ **Date:** _____

Enquiry Retrieval Quiz: Complete in black ink from memory. Do not peek at notes. Milestones: Q1–2 Bronze • Q3–4 Silver • Q5–6 Gold

13. ► Approximately how many Indian soldiers and labourers served the British Empire during the Great War?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

14. ► What acronym was given to the Australian and New Zealand Army Corps who landed at Gallipoli in 1915?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

15. ►► What strategic objective did Winston Churchill hope to achieve by attacking the Ottoman Empire at Gallipoli in 1915?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

16. ►► Why were soldiers of the British West Indies Regiment often denied front-line combat roles?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

17. ►►► Why was the global contribution of colonial and African troops largely erased from popular British memory after 1918?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

18. ►►► How did participation in the Great War accelerate demands for national independence across the British Empire?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Indian Army (1.3M) | ANZAC | Gallipoli (1915) | British West Indies Regt | Labour Corps | East Africa Campaign

Score: [/ 6]

How far did the First World War transform the British state and daily life on the Home Front?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 Aug 1914 • In what ways did DORA grant the British state unprecedented authoritarian control?

- State Control Under DORA
- Press Censorship Imposed
- Early Pub Closures

2 1915–1916 • What forced David Lloyd George to nationalise munitions factories in 1915?

- 1915 Daily Mail Headlines
- Frontline Shell Famine
- State Takes Over Output

3 Jan 1916 • Why did catastrophic frontline casualties force Britain to impose conscription in 1916?

- Voluntary System Exhausted
- Military Service Act Passed
- Conscientious Objectors

4 1916–1918 • How did 1 million "Canary Girls" transform industrial production despite toxic hazards?

- Toxic Jaundice Skin Yellowing
- Silvertown Explosion Risk
- 80% of All British Shells

5 1917–1918 • Why did unrestricted German submarine warfare push Britain to the brink of starvation?

- U-Boats Sink Merchantmen
- Six Weeks Food Reserve
- Compulsory Ration Books

Under DORA, it was illegal to buy rounds of drinks in pubs, feed bread to pigeons, ring church bells, or fly a kite in Britain.

Task A: Narrative Account [8 marks • 10 mins]

PART A • NARRATIVE

Write a narrative account analysing the key events leading from the Shell Crisis of 1915 to the introduction of compulsory conscription in 1916. [8 marks]

Stimulus: **The 1915 Shell Crisis and the Daily Mail headlines** | **The passing of the Military Service Act in January 1916**

Analytical Connectives: *The sequence of events began when... • This led to immediate political consequences because... • In response, the government intervened by... • Crucially, this proved necessary because... • Consequently, this resulted in...*
Key Terms: Shell Crisis • David Lloyd George • Ministry of Munitions • Lord Derby Scheme • Military Service Act (1916) • Conscription

Task B: Explain Importance [8 marks • 10 mins]

PART B • IMPORTANCE

Explain the importance of female munitions workers to the British war effort in the period 1915–1918. [8 marks]

Stimulus: **The production of 80% of all British weaponry and shells** | **The dangerous working conditions and toxic jaundice ("Canary Girls")**

Analytical Connectives: *The primary importance of this contribution was... • This was vital to the frontlines because... • Furthermore, the challenging conditions demonstrated that... • In the long term, this had a profound impact because...*
Key Terms: Canary Girls • TNT poisoning • Silvertown explosion • Ministry of Munitions • Representation of the People Act 1918

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 12–13

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 12–13 →

Milestone 5 (1916–1917): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 12–13). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out the 1916 Military Service Act conscription, 1 million female munitions workers ("Canary Girls"), and U-boat rationing.

Over 1 million women entered the wartime workforce; in January 1917, the Silvertown munitions factory in London exploded, killing 73 people and devastating 70,000 properties.

Testament of Youth

By Vera Brittain • Voluntary Aid Detachment (VAD) Nurse & Author

WARTIME AUTOBIOGRAPHY & NURSE MEMOIR (1915–1918)



Vera Brittain in her Voluntary Aid Detachment (VAD) uniform, 1915.

AUTHOR CONTEXT & HISTORICAL BACKGROUND:

Vera Brittain postponed her Oxford studies to volunteer as a VAD nurse, treating wounded British and German soldiers in London, Malta, and France. Having lost her fiancé, brother, and closest friends, her 1933 autobiography became the defining voice of the 'Lost Generation' of women.

SCAN FOR AUDIO READ-ALOUD (SEND)

The midnight hospital trains arrived in continuous succession, unloading hundreds of shattered, broken young men fresh from the slaughter of the Somme. Their khaki uniforms were caked in hardened trench clay, their eyes hollow with the haunting, unseeing stare of severe shell shock. Many lay motionless on stretchers along the cold corridors, unable to speak, their youth extinguished in a matter of hours by weapons their Victorian fathers could never have imagined.

In the surgical wards, we dressed wounds that made the heart turn cold—gangrenous limbs smelling of decay, agonizing chlorine gas burns that had stripped the delicate lining from human lungs, and faces torn away by jagged shards of flying shrapnel. We worked eighteen hours without respite, our aprons soaked with iodine and blood, our hands raw from carbolic acid, holding the trembling hands of dying eighteen-year-old boys who in their delirium mistook us for their mothers or sisters waiting at home.

...Meanwhile, across Britain, women were stepping forward to sustain the entire nation. We were driving omnibuses through darkened city streets, tilling the heavy soil in the Women's Land Army, and handling toxic cordite powder in explosive munitions factories. In the shell-filling plants, women's skin and hair turned bright yellow from toxic chemical exposure, earning them the nickname "Canary Girls." We proved beyond all doubt that women could carry the weight of an industrial empire in crisis. Yet as the casualty telegrams mounted daily, we realized with mounting grief that our reward would be mourning an entire generation of men who would never return to build a peacetime world.

VOCABULARY VAULT (KEY TERMINOLOGY):

VAD: Voluntary Aid Detachment: civilian volunteers providing nursing and medical care.
Shell Shock: Severe psychological trauma induced by prolonged artillery bombardment.
Canary Girls: Female munitions workers whose skin was stained yellow by toxic TNT chemicals.

PARENT & SCHOLAR ORAL DISCUSSION GUIDE:

Think: How did women's wartime experiences challenge Victorian stereotypes about women being frail? Discuss whether the 1918 vote for women over 30 was a fair reward for women's wartime sacrifices.

[ ] Oral Reading Verification: Scholar read extract aloud with expression & accuracy **Parent Initial:** _____ **Date:** _____

Enquiry Retrieval Quiz: Complete in black ink from memory. Do not peek at notes. Milestones: Q1–2 Bronze • Q3–4 Silver • Q5–6 Gold

19. ► What landmark law passed in August 1914 gave the British government sweeping emergency powers over daily life?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

20. ► What nickname was given to female munitions workers whose skin turned yellow from handling toxic TNT chemicals?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

21. ►► Why was compulsory conscription introduced for unmarried British men aged 18 to 41 in January 1916?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

22. ►► Why did the British government introduce compulsory food rationing for sugar, butter, and meat in early 1918?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

23. ►►► How did women's wartime work permanently shatter traditional Victorian gender stereotypes?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

24. ►►► To what extent did women's war work directly lead to women gaining the parliamentary vote in 1918?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: DORA (1914) | Munitionettes | Canary Girls | Rationing (1918) | Conscription (1916) | 1918 Representation Act

Score: [/ 6]

Did the Treaty of Versailles solve the problems of 1914, or create the nightmares of 1939?

AUDIO • QUIZ

1 11 Nov 1918 • What forced the German military to concede defeat and accept the Armistice in 1918?

- Kiel Sailors Mutiny
- Kaiser Flees to Holland
- Railway Armistice Signed

2 Jan–June 1919 • How did conflicting national motives divide Clemenceau, Lloyd George, and Wilson?

- Wilson's 14 Points Idealism
- Clemenceau Demands Revenge
- Lloyd George Imperial Trade

3 28 June 1919 • Why did Germans across all political parties denounce the Treaty terms as an unjust "Diktat"?

- Article 231 War Guilt Clause
- Crippling £6.6bn Bill
- Army Capped at 100,000

4 June–Dec 1919 • How did Article 231, Keynes' warning, and Will Dyson's cartoon predict future catastrophe?

- Keynes Carthaginian Peace
- Dyson 1940 Class Cartoon
- Predicting Second Conflict

5 1920–1939 • The Historical Verdict: Was Versailles an impossibly harsh peace or an unenforced compromise?

- German Industrial Core Intact
- Bitterness Exploited by Nazis
- Allied Will to Enforce Fails

John Maynard Keynes resigned from the British delegation in protest, warning the treaty would reduce Germany to starvation and bring down European civilization.

Enquiry Writing Task [12 marks • 15 mins]

'The Treaty of Versailles was so harsh that it made another European war inevitable.' How far do you agree with this statement? [12 marks]

Stimulus: **Article 231 (War Guilt) and £6.6 billion reparations** | **The establishment of the League of Nations and the principle of self-determination**

(Support each factor with your own precise historical evidence)

1. ECONOMIC & TERRITORIAL SEVERITY	2. SURVIVAL & REVISIONISM	3. COMPARATIVE VERDICT
Explain how Article 231, £6.6bn reparations, and the Polish Corridor bred revisionist fury in Germany.	Explain how Germany remained the dominant industrial power in Central Europe with its borders intact.	Weigh whether the treaty's terms or the subsequent Anglo-French failure to enforce them caused the 1939 collapse.

ANALYTICAL CONNECTIVES:

A compelling argument supporting this statement is that... • In particular, economic factors were significant because... • On the other hand, an alternative perspective is that... • Crucially, geopolitical balance demonstrated that... • In conclusion, the decisive reason was... because...

KEY VOCABULARY BANK:

Article 231 • £6.6 billion reparations • Diktat • Georges Clemenceau • David Lloyd George • Woodrow Wilson • Polish Corridor • John Maynard Keynes • League of Nations

Task: *Using the vocabulary and connectives above, write your analytical response below:*

MIND-MAP MISSION • PP. 12–13

Turn to Centrefold • Pages 12–13 →

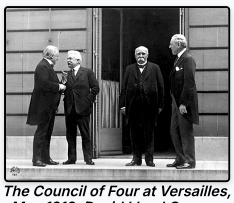
Milestones 7 & 8 (1918 & 1919): Turn to the Centrefold Mind-Map Canvas (Pages 12–13). Using the app's *Consolidate Station*, branch out the 1918 Hundred Days Offensive & Armistice alongside Article 231 War Guilt and £6.6bn reparations at Versailles.

Marshal Ferdinand Foch famously commented on the Treaty of Versailles: 'This is not peace. It is an armistice for twenty years.' World War II broke out twenty years and 64 days later.

The Economic Consequences of the Peace

By John Maynard Keynes • British Treasury Delegate to the 1919 Paris Peace Conference

POLITICAL & ECONOMIC EYEWITNESS ANALYSIS (1919)



The Council of Four at Versailles, May 1919: David Lloyd George, Vittorio Orlando, Georges Clemenceau, and Woodrow Wilson.

AUTHOR CONTEXT & HISTORICAL BACKGROUND:

John Maynard Keynes was a brilliant British Treasury economist who attended the 1919 Paris Peace Conference. Disgusted by the vindictive terms imposed on Germany, he resigned in protest and published this book warning that crushing the German economy would lead to economic catastrophe and future war.

SCAN FOR AUDIO READ-ALOUD (SEND)

The Council of Four assembled in the glittering Hall of Mirrors at Versailles, surrounded by gold and glass, but they were blind to the economic realities of the desperate continent they presumed to govern. Georges Clemenceau sat with his gloved hands folded across his chest, burning with an unrelenting desire to crush Germany permanently so that France might never again be invaded. Lloyd George pursued the fleeting demands of British electoral politics, promising angry voters that he would "squeeze the German lemon until the pips squeak." And President Woodrow Wilson, armed with noble principles of self-determination, proved tragically incapable of mastering the practical European negotiations.

Together, they drafted an ultimatum that treated Germany as a moral outlaw, compelling her delegates to sign Article 231—the War Guilt clause—under the imminent threat of renewed Allied invasion and starvation naval blockade. They demanded astronomical reparations running into billions of pounds, stripped the defeated nation of her merchant fleet, coalfields, and iron ore, yet demanded that she somehow generate vast surpluses of gold to pay her victors.

...I believe that the campaign for securing out of Germany the general costs of the war was one of the most serious acts of political unwisdom for which European statesmen have ever been responsible. If we aim deliberately at the impoverishment of Central Europe, vengeance, I dare predict, will not limp. By reducing seventy million people to perpetual poverty and humiliation, we are sowing dragon's teeth across the soil of Europe. Nothing can then delay that final civil war between the despairing forces of Reaction and Revolution, before which the horrors of the late German war will pale into insignificance.

VOCABULARY VAULT (KEY TERMINOLOGY):

Council of Four: The Allied leaders of Britain, France, the USA, and Italy at Versailles.
Article 231: The War Guilt clause forcing Germany to accept sole moral blame for the war.
Reparations: Compulsory financial payments demanded from Germany to cover Allied damages.

PARENT & SCHOLAR ORAL DISCUSSION GUIDE:

Think: What dark prophecy does Keynes make in his final sentence? Discuss whether the Treaty of Versailles was too harsh, or if the Allies failed because they refused to enforce it later.

[ ] Oral Reading Verification: Scholar read extract aloud with expression & accuracy **Parent Initial:** _____ **Date:** _____

Enquiry Retrieval Quiz: Complete in black ink from memory. Do not peek at notes. Milestones: Q1–2 Bronze • Q3–4 Silver • Q5–6 Gold

25. ► In what famous hall was the Treaty of Versailles signed on 28 June 1919, exactly five years after the assassination at Sarajevo?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

26. ► What controversial clause in the Treaty of Versailles (Article 231) forced Germany to accept sole moral blame for causing the war?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

27. ►► What staggering sum of financial reparations did the Inter-Allied Reparations Commission set for Germany to pay in 1921?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

28. ►► Why did German politicians and the public universally denounce the Treaty of Versailles as an unfair "Diktat"?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

29. ►►► How did the military restrictions of Versailles aim to prevent Germany from ever launching an offensive war again?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

30. ►►► Why did British political cartoonist Will Dyson portray a weeping toddler labeled "1940 Class" outside the Versailles peace conference?

Fact: _____

Explanation: _____

KEY TERM VAULT: Article 231 (War Guilt) | £6.6 Billion Reparations | Big Three | Diktat | Rhineland Demilitarisation | Keynes & Carthaginian Peace

Score: [/ 6]

KEY STAGE 3 HISTORICAL ASSESSMENT CRITERIA

Year 9 Pathway

EMERGING • FOUNDATIONAL RECALL
Identifies basic chronological milestones (1914 enlistment, trenches, 1918 Armistice). Completes Tier 1 retrieval questions with factual accuracy.

DEVELOPING • CAUSAL UNDERSTANDING
Explains primary causes of trench stalemate and the transition to total war. Links artillery firepower to the catastrophic breakdown on 1 July 1916.

SECURING • MULTI-CAUSAL ANALYSIS
Constructs balanced 12-mark arguments distinguishing military, imperial, and domestic catalysts. Integrates evidence from primary wartime memoirs.

GREATER DEPTH • HISTORIOGRAPHICAL VERDICT
Critically evaluates historical controversies (e.g. Haig's learning curve vs "Butcher" critique; Keynes's prophetic critique of Versailles).

DIGITAL DEPARTMENT MARKING BANK:
Scan the QR code to access the official department model answers, core factual criteria, and historical explanations for all 30 homework retrieval questions.

SCAN FOR ANSWERS

TEACHER TERMLY SYNOPTIC VERDICT:
[ ] Emerging [ ] Developing [ ] Securing [ ] Greater Depth

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